University of Zurich[UZH]

LEADERSHIP RESEARCH
Seminar, 3 ECTS

Dr. Ryan Miller
Prof. Dr. Lauren Howe
Prof. Dr. Jochen Menges
Chair of HRM and Leadership
Department of Business Administration, University of Zurich

COURSE CONTENT AND AIMS

Students will learn about how leadership research is produced. Students will receive hands-on experience in the research process and learn a mix of content, learning about the current leadership research landscape and how to conduct cutting-edge, rigorous leadership research. We begin by surveying topic areas in leadership research and identifying design and methodological issues. Then, we will focus our attention on designing rigorous research to answer the leadership questions of today (and tomorrow). In addition to practice with design and analytic techniques, students will also develop their academic writing skills in preparation for a Master thesis or other research-related writing.

COURSE AIMS

The primary purpose of this course is for students to learn how to conduct research on leadership and, more broadly, human behavior in organizations. Students will learn and discuss how research on leadership is produced and receive hands-on experience in the research process. This course will engage students in all the stages of research and prepare students to comprehend and work with leadership research and to allow them to produce such research themselves. This knowledge is valuable across multiple domains, and can be helpful for writing a master thesis at university, understanding and interpreting research throughout life, producing a trend report or an internal HR/talent development analysis in organizations, or conducting an informed analysis or critique of existing research.

EXPECTATIONS

To ensure the best learning experience, students are expected to attend all sessions and thoroughly prepare for class. Preparation for class includes reading the assigned materials, completing homework, and turning in all assigned work on time. Your attendance and participation impact your grade in class, but are also valuable as everyone benefits from a more positive learning environment and the class can become more interesting and fun.

LANGUAGE

The course will be in English.

AVAILABILITY

This course is supported by several instructors. For questions, coordination, or to arrange a personal meeting, please contact Dr. Ryan Miller at ryan.miller@business.uzh.ch.

TIMETABLE

Classes will take place between 16:15 and 18:00 on Thursdays throughout the Spring Semester 2026. The classroom is PLD-E-04.

Week	Date	Topic
1	19.02.2026	Introduction: Syllabus, and "What is Leadership?"
2	26.02.2026	Well-being and Leadership
3	05.03.2026	Qualitative Research Methods
4	12.03.2026	Research Questions and Introduction to Research Design
5	19.03.2026	Guest lecturer: Prof. Dr. Anand van Zelderen – AI Methods
6	26.03.2026	Guest lecturer: Dr. Zhuo Lin – Academic Writing
--	02.04.2026	--- No Class (Spring Break) ---
--	09.04.2026	--- No Class (Spring Break cont.) ---
7	16.04.2026	Guest lecturer: Prof. Dr. Mary Hausfeld – Research Design I
8	23.04.2026	Research Design II – Measurement
9	30.04.2026	Basics of Statistical Analysis I
10	07.05.2026	Basis of Statistical Analysis II – **Virtual Lecture**
--	14.05.2028	--- No Class (Ascension Day) ---
11	21.05.2026	Peer Feedback on Drafts
12	28.05.2026	Semi-open Office Hours

PROVISION OF COURSE MATERIALS ON OLAT & SOFTWARE USE

Slides will be available for download on OLAT. All readings are also available on OLAT.

The software R (https://www.r-project.org/) and R Studio (https://posit.co/downloads/) are required for statistical analysis weeks. These can easily be downloaded on personal computers before the relevant class sessions.

University of Zurich[UZH]

COURSE READINGS & HOMEWORK

Week	Date	Reading and Homework (due before class)
1	19.02.2026	--
2	26.02.2026	Martin, Ono, Russo, & Thomas (2023) **HW1:** Introduction Assignment (Qualtrics survey)
3	05.03.2026	Pratt (2025)
4	12.03.2026	"Topic Choice, Part #1" AMJ "Research design, Part #2" AMJ
5	19.03.2026	van Zelderen et al., (2024) *Optional:* Leavitt, K., Qiu, F., & Shapiro, D. L. (2019)
6	26.03.2026	"Setting the Hook, Part #3" AMJ **HW2:** Draft 2 research questions, identifying the IV and DV for each **-** Begin research data collection
--	02.04.2026	--- No Class (Spring Break) ---
--	09.04.2026	--- No Class (Spring Break) ---
7	16.04.2026	Research measurement **HW3:** Submit a peer check-in
8	23.04.2026	Stanton – A Checklist of Design Considerations for Survey Projects **HW4:** Draw a model of your research question **HW5:** Submit collected data
9	30.04.2026	Weiers (2007) – Simple Linear Regression and Correlation **HW6:** Install R and RStudio on your device
10	07.05.2026	R Problem Set **HW7:** Prepare a preliminary draft of your final paper to submit to your peer
--	14.05.2026	--- No Class (Ascension Day) ---
11	21.05.2026	**HW8:** Prepare a 1-page review of your peer's paper
12	28.05.2026	**HW9:** Final Paper Due 05.06.2025

The due date for all homework is always **Thursday at 15:00 before class**. For each day late, 10 percentage points are deducted from the grade. If you fail to submit the homework, you will receive a "0". Please submit all homework in your personal upload folder on OLAT.

There is no mandatory textbook, but the following readings could be of interest to students hoping to learn more about the different topics seen in class:

1. Design:
    a. Weiers, R. M. (2007). *Introduction to Business Statistics*.
    b. Lonati, S., Quiroga, B. F., Zehnder, C., & Antonakis, J. (2018). On doing relevant and rigorous experiments: Review and recommendations. *Journal of Operations Management*, *64*, 19-40.
    c. Wulff, J. N., Sajons, G. B., Pogrebna, G., Lonati, S., Bastardoz, N., Banks, G. C., & Antonakis, J. (2023). Common methodological mistakes. *The Leadership Quarterly*, *34*(1), 101677.

2. Data analysis:
    a. Allerhand, M. (2011). *A tiny handbook of R.*

3. Writing:
    a. Strunk, W., Jr., & White, E.B. (2000). *The Elements of Style* (4th ed.). New York: Pearson Longman.
    b. Pollock, T.G., & Bono, J.E. (2013). Being Scheherazade: The importance of storytelling in academic writing. *Academy of Management Journal, 56*(3), 629-634.

ASSESSMENT

The course will be assessed using three evaluation criteria:

1. **Attendance and Class Participation (15%):** Students will be evaluated on the extent to which they contributed to the learning of the class over the course semester. Contribution demands active participation, but this goes beyond simply speaking up in class. Contribution can look different for every student, but examples include asking thoughtful questions, engaging with other students' ideas, providing critique of the reading.
    a. Attendance (10%): Attendance will be taken at every class meeting. Students must attend at least 10 class meetings to receive full credit for attendance. With appropriate documentation, it is possible to have absences excused, at the discretion of the instructor.
    b. Participation (5%): Students are expected to contribute to class discussions and arrive prepared for class. Students must treat peers and the instructor with respect. You can bolster your participation grade by asking relevant questions, adding on to what other students have said, showing up to class on time and prepared, and demonstrating that you have completed the required readings.

2. **Homework (35%):**
    a. Introduction Assignment: Complete the Qualtrics survey introduction assignment.
    b. Various Homework: There are various homework assignments throughout the semester included in the course calendar. Submit these on time via OLAT to receive credit.
    - Pilot Flaws*Charisma data collection 10 people each
    c. Paper Deadlines: Complete a peer check-in (16.04.), prepare a preliminary draft of the final paper (07.05.), and submit a 1-page review of a classmate's paper (21.05.).

3. **Final Paper (50%):** The final paper consists of a research proposal. The deadline to submit your paper is **Friday, June 5th at 23:59**. There is no specific length requirement for the final paper. Please use the template included on OLAT, using 12-point Times New Roman font, double spacing, and standard margins. The paper will be graded according to the rubric, which is also available on OLAT. Critical elements include but are not limited to: quality of writing, use of appropriate structure, appropriateness of literature review, strength of hypotheses or research questions, appropriateness of research design, and appropriateness of analytic plan.